

that, if used properly, radiation could have important applications in both medicine and science.

Working to save lives

The Curies believed that knowledge should be shared and never attempted to profit from their discoveries. During World War I, Curie used the money she received for her Nobel Prize to fund 20 mobile X-ray units, nicknamed Petites (little) Curies, to be sent to the battlefield to scan wounded soldiers. She even drove one of the trucks herself and

trained others, including her daughter Irène, to take X-rays of the wounded. After the war, Curie helped to set up the Curie Foundation (now Institut Curie), which pioneered the first research into the treatment of cancer using radium. Curie toured the United States twice in order to raise money for this research.

Unfortunately, the detrimental effects of too much radiation meant that Curie's work was to prove fatal to her. She died of the bone marrow disease aplastic anemia at the age of 66, probably due to her prolonged exposure to radiation.

In 1894, Marie met Pierre in Paris. They would later marry and work collaboratively. Their joint research on the properties of radioactivity won them the Nobel Prize in 1903.

**THE FIRST
WOMAN
TO WIN A
NOBEL
PRIZE**

**DONATED HER
NOBEL
MEDALS
IN WORLD
WAR I**



**ONE GRAM
OF RADIUM
COST
\$100,000
IN 1921**

